

YUL OMAR VILLANUEVA

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CAREER SUMMARY

I'm a **Lead Software Development Engineer in Test** with over 12 years of experience, but my real focus is on what's next for automation. Lately, I've been moving beyond traditional scripts to build Agentic QA frameworks. I specialize in creating AI agents (using Claude) that don't just run tests, but actually think through them by integrating Jira for context(Tickets), generating test cases on the fly, and using MCP (Model Context Protocol) with Playwright for execution.

Throughout my career in Agile and SAFe environments, I've scaled frameworks with Selenium and Appium that cut regression cycles by 70%. Whether I'm standing up a CI/CD pipeline in Azure DevOps or mentoring a team toward full automation, my goal is always the same: building stable, intelligent systems that let engineers ship faster without the manual headache.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **AI & Agentic Automation:** Architecting AI agents (Claude) to bridge the gap between Jira requirements and execution. Expert in Model Context Protocol (MCP) with Playwright for intelligent, autonomous test execution and automated test case generation.
- **Automation Ecosystems:** 12+ years building and scaling frameworks from scratch using Selenium WebDriver (Java, C#) and Appium for cross-platform mobile (iOS/Android). Strong focus on Playwright, Cucumber (BDD), TDD, and ATDD.
- **Modern DevOps & Orchestration:** Designing seamless CI/CD pipelines within Azure DevOps, Jenkins, and GitHub Actions. Skilled in Maven, Git, and API testing/performance via Postman and JMeter.
- **Strategic Leadership:** Leading QA digital transformations in Agile/SAFe environments. I focus on technical training, rigorous code reviews, and mentoring teams to transition from manual testing to a full automation-first mindset.
- **Data & Integration:** Managing complex test data within Microsoft SQL and integrating disparate platforms (like n8n or custom APIs) to create a unified automation workflow.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Lead SDET / Acting QA Manager | Sprout Solutions | Apr 2024 – Present

Leadership & Strategic Management (March 2026 – Present)

Engineering-Wide QA Leadership: Stepped into an acting managerial role, leading a high-performing team of 11 SDETs and 11 QA. I oversee the entire Quality Engineering strategy across the Product Team, ensuring quality is baked into the development lifecycle from day one.

Executive Visibility: Representing the QA organization in L10 leadership meetings, aligning technical testing roadmaps with high-level business goals and reporting on critical quality metrics to executive stakeholders.

Modernizing the Stack (Agentic QA): Currently architecting a next-generation Agentic Framework using Claude and MCP (Model Context Protocol). I'm moving the needle from simple automation to "Intelligent Testing," integrating Jira with Playwright to autonomously generate and execute test cases based on real-time ticket updates.

Technical Impact & Innovation (Apr 2024 – March 2026)

Performance Engineering: Optimized our Selenium C# framework for Payroll, slashing regression runtime from 17 minutes down to 5 minutes—directly enabling a 3x increase in deployment frequency.

Democratizing Quality: Introduced no-code API testing tools, which cut test development time by 40% and empowered our non-technical QA members to contribute to the automation suite.

Cross-Departmental Efficiency: Extended our automation capabilities to Sales and Customer Advocacy, building custom tools that reduced their manual data preparation time by 80%.

AI Adoption: Championed the use of GitHub Copilot and ChatGPT within the engineering team to streamline code reviews and script generation, significantly shortening our delivery cycles.

Infrastructure Stability: Built and maintained robust CI/CD pipelines in Azure DevOps, ensuring every deployment is guarded by automated smoke tests to prevent regressions in production.

- **Senior Software Engineer** – Automation Lead & Trainer | Sprout Solutions | Sept 2019 – Apr 2024
 - Designed and implemented web and mobile automation frameworks (Java, Python, Selenium, Appium).
 - Built regression test packages and integrated in-sprint automation, accelerating release cycles.
 - Trained and mentored QA engineers, significantly increasing automation adoption.
 - Created mobile automation pipeline reducing manual regression efforts by 40%.
 - Standardized automation coding practices, reducing script maintenance time.
 - Acted as QA lead for Product Increment Planning (PIP) sessions.
- **Associate Consultant** – Automation Tester & Trainer | Capgemini Philippines | Jul 2018 – Jul 2019

- Developed and maintained automated scripts from functional test cases.
- Conducted Selenium training sessions for employees.
- Built automation frameworks that enhanced testing efficiency.
- **Software Engineer Testing Analyst** – Automation Test Lead | Accenture | Feb 2015 – Jul 2018
 - Led in-sprint automation initiatives in Agile teams, increasing automation adoption.
 - Established automation guidelines and coding standards.
 - Performed defect triage and coordinated with developers for faster resolution.
- IT System Management Support | Jocker's Foods Industries | Mar 2013 – Apr 2014
 - Provided IT system support and implemented biometric systems for timekeeping.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Engineering | Bulacan State University | 2007 – 2013

CERTIFICATIONS & TRAINING

- Agile Software Development
- Selenium Automation Training
- Python Fundamentals
- Java Cross-Skill Training
- JMeter & Performance Testing
- SQL Management
- Certified Tester Foundation Level (ISTQB)